



Google Ideas

Google has unveiled "Google Ideas" project with the help of INFO to start the fight against drug cartels and other illicit networks. <http://dgit.in/OBLF7e>

Twitter for Nokia

Symbian, the most widely used mobile platform now offers their official twitter application on Nokia Series 40 <http://dgit.in/Oe5T5k>

HOW WE TESTED

Most users are not used to Linux and would like to have a dual boot with some version of Windows. Hence, we installed a fresh copy of Windows 7 for each distro on our test machine with the following specs: Intel Core 2 Duo E6320 processor with 3 GB 667 MHz RAM, a 320 GB HDD and a NVIDIA 9500GT all fitted on an MSI MS-7380 motherboard. We intentionally selected an older rig to ensure performance differences on the software level were distinctly visible. Also, since Linux is known to support older hardware well enough, this gave us an opportunity to see if there were any problems with that assumption – well there were none.

We then popped in the DVD of the distro and went through the installation under default settings (except for Slackware where we manually partitioned the drive) and observed how well the installer went along with the existing Windows installation. We also observed how complicated the installation process was and noted trouble areas. After installation, we first noticed the amount of memory and CPU usage and then explored the various software applications that came along and their features in detail.

Next in line were the various performance tests. We rebooted the machine to record the time taken

for bootup, hibernation and shutdown. We then tested how easy it was to install and remove software as we installed Phoronix test suite (and any other dependencies) and ran a complex system test. A graphics performance test using glxgears application was next and then came performance tests for the default browser, media player and compression software. In case the distro did not support media codecs, we installed VLC media player and tested it with an MKV file at a 1080p resolution. Compression software tests came next where we compressed a 5.4 GB folder, with an ample number of documents and media files, into a ZIP file and noted the time taken and size of the resultant file. In the end we tested how good the latest version of Firefox (13.0.1 at the time of writing) was against the default browser that came along with the distro – this also gives an overview of browser performance in the distro.

NOTE: glxgears was used for graphics performance test. It is not deemed as the ideal method for testing graphics performance for Linux, but is recommended in the absence of tools and again, it does show how well the graphics driver in use performs. Do note that we did not install any extra drivers.

OpenSUSE is its one-click install feature. It allows you to search for the required software on the OpenSUSE website and download a small file. When you double-click on this file, it launches the installer and lets you install software on your system (assuming you are connected to the internet). This is much easier for an average user who is used to the software install procedure on Windows machines. Again, the one-click install process allows you to subscribe to new repositories without the need for extra tools. OpenSUSE doesn't include popular media codecs, so you would have to install VLC media player over the internet.

Some users complain about the confusion between YaST and KDE's control center and it is indeed confusing in the beginning as same settings can be found at both places. The simple

way here is to not use the administrative parts of KDE's control center and rather use YaST for those. OpenSUSE deploys `systemd` for bootup and it's very fast (have a look at the table) compared to any other distro. We would say that if you want maximum control, the best performance, and a lot of additional options to play along with, at the expense of a comparatively complex installer, go for OpenSUSE!

On the downside, the steps for upgrading from one version of OpenSUSE to another higher version (without using the DVD) aren't really simple. Using a DVD to update to the next version is still the recommended way. Unlike Ubuntu, it

won't need extra space or slow the system down because of the leftovers after the upgrade process is complete. OpenSUSE stood out with its above par performance, fast boot-up times, advanced installer and a really powerful control center. Not to mention the default KDE interface was fast as well as friendly. With such features and performance, OpenSUSE comes



OpenSUSE 12.1

out as a clear winner, unambiguously bagging the Best Performer crown.

UBUNTU 12.04

Ubuntu has certainly been the constant winner of popularity contests held every now and then among Linux distros, and that's because it's very simple to use. Right from its installer to the software center or UI, everything is simple. However, if you aren't used to a vertical taskbar on the left edge of your screen, it will start irritating you in no time. The options and flexibility for an average user are not enough and at times, can get confusing. Hence, if you have been exposed to a Windows interface for long, Ubuntu is something which would not suit your taste for one simple reason – its interface. However, if you are a beginner who wants everything simple and non-confusing, go with Ubuntu, but remember that none of its default interfaces – either Unity or Gnome – look like Windows.

Its software center being simple can be a good or bad thing. Good, because it is easy – you search for software, select the entry, click Install and you're done. It will resolve dependencies, download them and install without bothering you for anything. Bad, because it would not show you the total download size or ongoing download speed. Again, you cannot cancel the download when it is happening and on slower connections, is certainly a disadvantage.

Nonetheless, it is still popular and brings in new innovations into the Linux arena. It is the simplicity which makes Ubuntu a must-try distro in the end. The best thing here: update from one version to another higher one without reinstalling anything. Although that will eat